

Static GK Test -21

Q1. Which of these books is written by Shashi Tharoor?

- (a) A State of Freedom
- (b) Why I am Hindu**
- (c) Autumn
- (d) Songs of a Coward

Solution: 5.(b) Why I am Hindu. Other books of Shashi Tharoor: "Inglorious Empire", "The Paradoxical Prime Minister", "Ambedkar: A Life", "The Great Indian Novel", "An Era of Darkness" (Sahitya Akademi Award 2019), "Pax Indica", "Tharoorosaurus", "The Battle of Belonging", "The Hindu Way", "The Struggle for India's Soul". A State of Freedom: Neel Mukherjee. Songs of a Coward: Perumal Murugan.

Q2. Padavali Kirtan refers to songs composed in the medieval period of West Bengal (15 th to 17 th century) in praise of _____.

- (a) Shakti
- (b) Vishnu**
- (c) Shiva
- (d) Brahma

Solution: 17 . (b) The term padavali literally means "gathering of songs". Padavali Kirtan refers to songs composed in praise of Vishnu.

Q3. Which among the following is NOT a component of Lion Capital at Sarnath, India?

- (a) Carved cow representing South direction**
- (b) Figures of 4 lions
- (c) Dharma Chakras
- (d) Lotus base bell

Solution: 6.(a) Carved cow representing South direction . The top of the column—the capital—has three parts. First, a base of a lotus flower (ubiquitous symbol of Buddhism). Then, a drum on which four animals are carved represents the four cardinal directions: a horse (west), an ox (east), an elephant (south), and a lion (north). Four lions stand at top of the drum, each facing in the four cardinal directions.

Q4. Which state is famous for celebrating the Majuli festival?

- (a) Manipur
- (b) Assam**
- (c) Sikkim
- (d) Meghalaya

Solution: 12 .(b) Assam. Majuli festival is celebrated on the banks of the River Luit in Majuli island (world largest river island) in the month of November. Other festivals of Assam: Bihu, Ambubachi festival, Baishagu. Manipur - Ningol Chakouba, Cheiraoba, Gang-Ngai. Sikkim - Maghe Sankranti, Saga Dawa, Bhanu Jayanti. Meghalaya - Shad Suk Mynsiem, Nongkrem, Behdienkhlam.

Q5. As per Census 2011 , what is the Total Fertility Rate (an approximate range) in India?

- (a) 3.1 - 3.9
- (b) 2.1 - 2.9**
- (c) 5.1 - 5.9
- (d) 4.1 - 4.9

Solution: 2 .(b) The Total Fertility Rate (TFR) for India as per the census 2011 was 2.4 per woman. The total fertility rate of India stands at 2 as of 2021 . In rural areas of India, the Fertility rate is 2.1 & in Urban areas of India, it ' s 1.6 . Among the bigger States, it varies from 1.8 in Tamil Nadu and West Bengal to 3 in Bihar.

Q6. The Deccan festival is a five-day long festival which reflects the culture of the Deccan. The festival is associated with which state?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Maharashtra
- (d) Andhra Pradesh**

Solution: 8.(d) Famous festivals of Andhra Pradesh: Deccan Festival, Pongal (Observed At The Inception Of The Harvesting Season), Ugadi (Celebrated As The New Year's Day), Rottela Panduga, Prabhala Theertham, Visakha Utsav (Amazing Cultural Festival In South India), Tirupati Tirumala Brahmotsavam , Lumbini Festival (Highlights Buddhist Culture), Rayalaseema Food & Dance Festival , etc.

Q7. PSLV Orbital Experimental Module (POEM) is associated with which

organization?

- (a) DRDO
- (b) HAL
- (c) BHEL
- (d) ISRO**

Solution: 11.(d) ISRO. POEM has a Navigation Guidance and Control system for attitude stabilisation. PSLV - Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle. GSLV - Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle. ISRO: Headquarters - Bengaluru. Established - 1969. Chairman - Shri S. Somanath (as of April 2023).

Q8. The ' Lezim ' dance form is peculiar to which of the following states?

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Bihar
- (c) Maharashtra**
- (d) Gujarat

Solution: 3 .(c) The ' Lezim ' dance form is peculiar to Maharashtra. Lezim is especially popular in rural Maharashtra, often played during the Ganesh festival. The other main folk dances of Maharashtra are Lavani, Dhargarigaja, Koli, Gondhal, and Tamasha.

Q9. Who founded the Lucknow gharana of Kathak?

- (a) Sitara Devi
- (b) Ishwari Prasad**
- (c) Birju Maharaj
- (d) Rukmini Devi

Solution: 14 .(b) Ishwari Prasad: Padma Bhushan (1984). There are 4 Gharanas of Kathak: Lucknow Gharana, Jaipur Gharana (founded by Bhanu Ji Maharaj), Banaras Gharana (Founded by Janakiprasad), Raigarh Gharana (Maharaja Chakradhar Singh). Kathak Dancer - Sitara devi, Birju Maharaj. Bharatanatyam dancer - Rukmini Devi.

Q10. Which among the following books is written by Amitav Ghosh?

- (a) Back to the Roads
- (b) 400 Days
- (c) Jungle Nama**
- (d) Battlefield

Solution: 4.(c) Jungle Nama. Other books of Amitav Ghosh: "Sea of Poppies", "The Hungry Tide", "The Shadow Lines", "The Glass Palace", "River of Smoke", "Gun Island", "Flood of Fire", "The Nutmeg's Curse", "In an Antique Land", "The Living Mountain", "Uncanny and Improbable Events". 400 Days: Chetan Bhagat. Battlefield: Vishram Bedekar. Back Roads: Tawni O'Dell.

Q11. Which of the following teams won the first edition of ISL (Indian Super League)?

- (a) Bengaluru FC
- (b) Chennaiyin FC
- (c) Atletico de Kolkata**
- (d) Kerala Blasters FC

Solution: 8 .(c) Atletico de Kolkata won the first edition of Indian Super League in 2013 . Hyderabad FC won the 2022 ISL title.

Q12. Rita performs 'Giddha' dance form. Which state does this dance form belong to?

- (a) Punjab**
- (b) Rajasthan
- (c) Haryana
- (d) Uttarakhand

Solution: 14.(a) Famous Dances of Punjab are Bhangra, Giddha, Sammi, Kikli, Jhoomer, Jaago, Dankara or Gatka Dance, Malawi, Julli, Luddi, etc.

Q13. Which state of India has set up District Investment Promotion Agencies (DIPA)?

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Haryana
- (c) Odisha**
- (d) West Bengal

Solution: 5 .(c) Odisha Government has set up District Investment Promotion Agencies (DIPA) to promote and facilitate investment across the State.

Q14. In which state is Ponu Yoksi, a sword-like instrument, used during ceremonial dances performed by priests?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Arunachal Pradesh**
- (c) Madhya Pradesh
- (d) Himachal Pradesh

Solution: 6 .(b) In Arunachal Pradesh, Ponu Yoksi, a sword-like instrument, is used during ceremonial dances performed by priests. Ponu yoksi is a Solid instrument. Another Musical instruments popular in Arunachal Pradesh are Ujuk Tapu (wind instrument), Jingre Tapu (wind instrument), Pipe Tapu (wind instrument), kiring (Solid instrument), Emul (Solid instrument), Pui (string instrument), Guga (string instrument).

Q15. Which of the following dances is popularly known as the Gotipua Dance?

- (a) Garba
- (b) Bandha Nritya**
- (c) Bhangra
- (d) Lavani

Solution: 6 .(b) Bandha Nritya is popularly known as Gotipua Dance (Odisha). Garba Gujarat, Bhangra Punjab, Lavani Maharashtra.

Q16. Ishwari Prasad is associated with which of the following Indian classical dances?

- (a) Manipuri
- (b) Kathak**
- (c) Kathakali
- (d) Bharatanatyam

Solution: 13 .(b) Kathak. Ishwari Prasad - He founded the Lucknow Gharana. Classical dances and prominent figures : Kathak (Uttar Pradesh) - Birju Maharaj, Shovana Narayan, Sitara Devi. Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu) - Padma Subrahmanyam, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Mallika Sarabhai. Kathakali (Kerala) - Kottakkal Sivaraman, Ramankutty Nair, Kalamandalam Gopi. Manipuri (Manipur) - Darshana Jhaveri, Yumlembam Gambhini Devi, Guru Bipin Singh.

Q17. In which state of India is Konark dance festival celebrated?

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Odisha**
- (c) Jharkhand
- (d) Rajasthan

Solution: 2.(b) Famous dances of Odisha: Konark dance, Chhau dance, Gotipua dance , Odissi dance, Ghumura dance, Ranapa dance, Jodi Sankha dance, Chaiti Ghoda dance, Sambalpuri folk dance, Bhaga nacha, and Paika Nritya.

Q18. Who among the following is a famous Sitar player?

- (a) Ustad Rehman Khan
- (b) Kishan Maharaj
- (c) Ali Ahmad Hussain
- (d) Anoushka Shankar**

Solution: 3 .(d) Anoushka Shankar (Daughter of Ravi Shankar) Sitar Player. Ustad Rehman Khan Pakhwaj Player. Kishan Maharaj Tabla Player. Ali Ahmad Hussain Shehnai Player.

Q19. Noted dancer Birju Maharaj bagged the Filmfare award for best Choreographer for which film in 2016?

- (a) Befikre
- (b) Dangal
- (c) Mohenjo Daro**
- (d) Bajirao Mastani

Solution: 4 .(c) Bajirao Mastani (Song - Mohe Rang Do Laal) . Birju Maharaj (Brij Mohan Nath Mishra) - Famous Kathak dancer belonged to the Kalka-Bindadin gharana of Lucknow. Awards - Padma Vibhushan (1986), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1964), Kalidas Samman (1987), National Film Award for choreography in the film Vishwaroopam (2012), Honorary doctorates from Banaras Hindu University and Khairagarh University.

Q20. Who among the following is referred to as ' Prince of Bhangra ', due to his Bhangra music?

- (a) Diljit Dosanjh
- (b) Sukhbir Singh**
- (c) Arijit Singh
- (d) Shaan

Solution: 10 .(b) Sukhbir Singh (Indian singer) is often referred to as the "Prince of Bhangra". He was nominated and won the 1996 Channel V Awards in three categories: Best Debut Album, Best Male Vocalist and Best Music Video (for "Punjabi Munde") for his first album ' New Style '. Bhangra is a type of traditional folk dance of Punjab, originating in the Sialkot area of Punjab.

Q21. Mohiniyattam is a classical dance form of which Indian state?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Kerala**
- (c) Tamil Nadu
- (d) Assam

Solution: 4 .(b) Mohiniyattam, Kathakali Kerala, Kuchipudi Andhra Pradesh, Bharatnatyam Tamil Nadu, Sattriye Assam.

Q22. Which of the following books was written by Indian author RK Narayan?

- (a) The White Tiger
- (b) Think Like a Monk
- (c) The Shadow Lines
- (d) Malgudi Days**

Solution: 3.(d) Most Popular Books by R.K Narayan : 'Malgudi Days' , 'The Ramayana: A Shortened Modern Prose Version of the Indian Epic', 'The Guide', 'The Mahabharata: A Shortened Modern Prose Version of the Indian Epic', 'Swami and Friends', etc. 'The White Tiger' (Aravind Adiga); 'Think Like a Monk' (Jay Shetty); 'The Shadow Lines' (Amitav Ghosh).

Q23. With which of the following states is the ' Sao Joao ' festival associated?

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Kerala
- (c) Goa**
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Solution: 13 .(c) The ' Sao Joao ' festival is associated with Goa. It is an annual Catholic festival celebrated on June 24 . During this festival young Goan Catholic men leap into and swim in local wells, streams and ponds as a tribute to St. John, The Baptist.

Q24. Which festival has the meaning 'to boil' or 'boiling' in its name ?

- (a) Pongal**
- (b) Onam
- (c) Raja
- (d) Bihu

Solution: 7.(a) Pongal (harvest festival) - considered to be one of the major festivals of South India and it is mainly celebrated in Tamil Nadu. Other harvest festivals of India : Onam - Kerala. Raja Parba or (Mithuna Sankranti) - Odisha. Bihu - Assam. Lohri - Punjab. Baisakhi - Punjab and Haryana.

Q25. Bhagwant Singh Mann is an Indian politician and current Chief Minister of Punjab. He was formerly a _____.

- (a) comedian**
- (b) cricketer
- (c) writer
- (d) singer

Solution: 9.(a) Comedian . Bhagwant Mann (17th Chief Minister of Punjab), Constituency - Dhuri . He was also a member of the Lok Sabha from Sangrur Lok Sabha constituency from 2014 to 2022.

Q26. 'Chinkara' is a _____ musical instrument popular in the state of Madhya Pradesh.

- (a) plate
- (b) membrane
- (c) stringed**
- (d) wind

Solution: 8 .(c) Chinkara is a stringed musical instrument popular in the state of Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan. It is made of parchment, wood and steel. This instrument is used by the ' Pradhan ' community of Madhya Pradesh and the ' Meo ' community of Rajasthan.

Q27. Which of the following festivals is celebrated when the annual harvest takes place in Assam?

- (a) Lohri
- (b) Pongal
- (c) Magh Bihu**

(d) Makaravilakku

Solution: 1 .(c) Magh Bihu Assam, Lohri Punjab, Pongal is one of the most important festivals celebrated by Tamil people in Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Puducherry in India. Makaravilakku is an annual festival held on Makara Sankranti in Kerala, India at the shrine of Sabarimala.

Q28. The Dronacharya Award was first handed out in 1985, and the first Dronacharya Award winner was _____.

- (a) Hansa Sharma
- (b) Karan Singh
- (c) Bhalchandra Bhaskar Bhagwat**
- (d) Hawa Singh

Solution: 12.(c) First Dronacharya Award winner - Bhalchandra Bhaskar Bhagwat (wrestling), O.M. Nambiar (athletics) and Om Prakash Bharadwaj (boxing). The first woman to win the Dronacharya Award - Hansa Sharma (weightlifting - 2000). 2nd Woman - Renu Kohli (athletics - 2002). Dronacharya Award - It is given to honor eminent coaches.

Q29. _____ is one of the most popular folk dances of Odisha.

- (a) Giddha
- (b) Hojagiri
- (c) Dalkhai**
- (d) Rauf

Solution: 4 .(c) Dalkhai is one of the most popular folk dances of Odisha. Other folk dances belonged to – Gidha (Punjab), Hojagiri (Tripura) and Rauf (Jammu and Kashmir).

Q30. In which of the following months is the ' Valvil Ori Vizha ' festival of Tamil Nadu celebrated?

- (a) June
- (b) January
- (c) May
- (d) August**

Solution: 9 .(d) The ' Valvil Ori Vizha ' festival of Tamil Nadu is celebrated in August. It is celebrated in a grand manner in the Kolli Hills of Tamil Nadu.

Q31. U. Srinivas is a famous player of which of the following instruments?

- (a) Mandolin**
- (b) Violin
- (c) Sitar
- (d) Guitar

Solution: 5 .(a) Mandolin - S Balamurali Krishna, Nagen Dey, Khagen Dey. Violin - Lalgudi Jayaram, VG Jog, M Chandrasekharan, NR Murlidharan, MS Gopalakrishnan. Sitar - Ustad Vilayat Khan, Pt Ravi Shankar, Shujaat Hussain Khan, Shahid Parvez Khan, Anushka Shankar, Nikhil Banerjee, Mustaq Ali Khan, Budhaditya Mukherjee. Guitar - Amyt Dutta , Braj Bhushan Kabra. Uppalapu Srinivas - Padma Shri (1998), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (2010), National Citizens Award (1991).

Q32. Which of the following is a cattle fair celebrated in the state of Himachal Pradesh?

- (a) Doongri Festival
- (b) Manimahesh Fair
- (c) Ashwin Mela
- (d) Nalwari Fair**

Solution: 16 .(d) Nalwari Fair is a cattle fair celebrated in the Bilaspur district of Himachal Pradesh. Doongri Festival also known as Hidimba Devi Fair is celebrated in Kullu on the occasion of Basant Panchami. Manimahesh Fair is a 14 day fair celebrated in Himachal Pradesh on the occasion of the birth of Lord Vishnu. Ashwin Navratri Mela is celebrated in Himachal Pradesh and Ashwin Amavasya Mela is celebrated in Uttar Pradesh.

Q33. ' The Race of My Life : An Autobiography ' is the autobiography of which of the following persons?

- (a) Dutee Chand
- (b) Tintu Luka
- (c) PT Usha
- (d) Milkha Singh**

Solution: 11 .(d) " Race of my Life: An Autobiography " Milkha Singh, " Golden girl " PT Usha.

Q34. Surat is also known as _____ of India.

(a) Diamond city

- (b) Blue city
- (c) Pink City
- (d) City of Lakes

Solution: 13.(a) Diamond city. It is also known as "The silk city", and "The green city". Surat (located on the River Tapi) has been called "The gateway to Mecca". Old name of Surat - Suryapur. The length of Gujarat's coastline - 1214.7 km. First permanent British factory was established at Surat in 1613.

Q35. In which year was the 'Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana' launched?

- (a) 2019
- (b) 2015**
- (c) 2014
- (d) 2020

Solution: 11 . (b) 2015. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana : promotes skill development in the country by providing free short-duration skill training and incentivizes this by providing monetary rewards to youth for skill certification. Ministry - Skill Development and Entrepreneurship. Other Important Schemes : Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) - 2014, Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY) - 2015, Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana - 2015, Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi Yojana or PM-KISAN Yojana - 2019.

Q36. In basketball, a free-throw is worth how many points?

- (a) 1**
- (b) 2
- (c) 3
- (d) 4

Solution: 15 .(a) In Basketball free throws are worth one point. A traditional basketball team has 12 players, with five basketball players on the court at any given time.

Q37. Makaravilakku is an annual festival held on Makar Sankranti in which of the following states?

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Kerala**
- (d) Odisha

Solution: 11 .(c) Makaravilakku is an annual festival held on Makar Sankranti in Kerala at the shrine of Sabarimala. The festival includes the Thiruvabharanam (sacred ornaments of Lord Ayyappan) procession and a congregation at the hill shrine of Sabarimala.

Q38. ' Float Festival ' is one of the main festivals celebrated in _____.

- (a) Kannur
- (b) Madurai**
- (c) Puducherry
- (d) Kanyakumari

Solution: 14 .(b) ' Float Festival ' is one of the main festivals celebrated in Madurai. It takes place on the full moon night of the Tamil month, Thai, which falls between mid-January and mid-February. The concept of the festival dates back to the 17 th century when it was celebrated for the first time by King Thirumalai Nayak

Q39. Which of the following lines is NOT related to kabaddi?

- (a) Baulk line
- (b) Attack line**
- (c) Bonus line
- (d) End line

Solution: 6 .(b) Attack line. International Kabaddi Federation (Headquarters - Jaipur, India) : Highest governing body . Related terms : Cant (Recitation of word 'Kabaddi'), Raider (Who enters the court of the opponent), Raid (Entering Opponent's court) etc. Tournaments - World Cup, Asian Games, Pro Kabaddi League etc. Players - Pardeep Narwal, Anup Kumar, Deepak Niwas Hooda, Pawan Sehrawat.

Q40. _____ is the international air carrier of India and handles foreign traffic, which includes both cargo and passenger services.

- (a) Air India**
- (b) Pawan Hans
- (c) Dove Airlines
- (d) Taj Air

Solution: 13.(a) Air India. It is the flag carrier airline of India, headquartered in

New Delhi. Owned by Talace Private Limited. The airline was founded by J. R. D. Tata as Tata Airlines in 1932. It became the first Asian airline to induct a jet aircraft into its fleet on 21 October 1960. Natarajan Chandrasekaran (Chairman). Pawan Hans (National Helicopter), Dove Airline (Airline charter based in Kolkata), Taj Air (Charter airline; Mumbai).

Q41. Intermediate Range Ballistic Missile Ag ni-4 has been successfully test fired in _____

- (a) Pokhran Firing Range, Rajasthan
- (b) Neil Island, Andaman and Nicobar Islands
- (c) Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh
- (d) **APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha**

Solution: 2.(d) APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha. The Agni-IV (range 4000 Km) is a two-stage surface-to-surface missile. It has been developed by DRDO (Defence Research and Development Organisation). It is 20 metres long with a weight of 17 tonnes. Agni I (range of 700-800 kms), Agni II (around range 2000 kms), Agni III (around range 2,500 kms), Agni-V : (longest missile in the Agni series, with a range of nearly 5,000 kms), Agni-P (Prime) (canisterized missile with a range of 1,000 to 2,000kms and will replace the Agni-I missile).

Q42. Which among the following is a surface-to-surface missile of India?

- (a) Javelin
- (b) AIM-120 AMRAAM
- (c) Spike
- (d) **Agni V**

Solution: 7.(d) Agni V { (range around 5000 km -5500 km), developed by Defence Research and Development Organisation} is a ballistic missile developed under the Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme (IGMDP). On October 27, 2021, (test fired on) the country celebrated 75th infantry day. The missiles developed under IGMDP are Prithvi, Agni, Trishul, Akash, Nag.

Q43. In which of the following states is the ' Eco Retreat ' festival held every year?

- (a) Bihar
- (b) Assam
- (c) **Odisha**
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Solution: 12 . (c) The ' Eco Retreat ' festival is held every year in Odisha. The objective of this festival is to attract tourists as well as private sectors for investment here.

Q44. Who is known as the 'Father of Modern Dance i n India'?

- (a) **Uday Shankar**
- (b) Birju Maharaj
- (c) Gopi Krishna
- (d) Guru Bipin Singh

Solution: 8 . (a) Uday Shankar - Major dancer and choreographer of India whose adaptation of Western theatrical techniques to traditional Hindu dance popularized the ancient art form in India, Europe, and the United States . Awards : Sangeet Natak Akademi (1962), Padma Vibhushan in (1971). Birju Maharaj (Father of Kathak, Lucknow "Kalka-Bindadin" Gharana), Gopi Krishna (Kathak dancer), Guru Bipin Singh (Father of Manipuri Dance).

Q45. Which of the following is the state of origin of the Odissi dance form?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) **Odisha**
- (c) Tamil Nadu
- (d) Kerala

Solution: 7.(b) Odissi is one of the principal classical dance styles of India; It is indigenous to Odisha, eastern India, and follows the principles of the Natya-shastra. Other classical dances include Bharata Natyam, Kuchipudi, Kathak, Kathakali, and Manipuri.

Q46. ' Bolak-aat ' is a _____ from the state of Karnataka.

- (a) music form
- (b) painting form
- (c) **dance form**
- (d) sculpting form

Solution: 2 .(c) Bolak-aat ' is a dance form from the Kodagu region of the state of Karnataka. This dance form is performed by Kodava men in the back of an oil lamp in an open field. The men hold chiavari (yak fur) in one hand and the Kodava short sword (odi-kathi) in the other while performing this dance.

Q47. Ghoomar is a folk-dance form from the state of _____.

- (a) Tripura
- (b) **Rajasthan**
- (c) Bihar
- (d) Jharkhand

Solution: 5 .(b) Ghoomar is a folk-dance form from the state of Rajasthan. This dance is performed by the Bhil tribe of Rajasthan to worship the goddess Sarasvati. Other folk dances of Rajasthan include Bhavai, Chakri, Chari, Drum dance, Fire Dance and many more.

Q48. Who among the following was the first-ever badminton player from India to clinch an Olympic medal?

- (a) Srikanth Kidambi
- (b) **Saina Nehwal**
- (c) Chirag Shetty
- (d) PV Sindhu

Solution: 15.(b) Saina Nehwal (2012). She is the first Indian badminton player to have won an Olympic medal, and the first Indian to have reached the final of the BWF World Championships. Awards:- Arjuna Award (2009), Padma Shri (2010), Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna (2010), Padma Bhushan (2016). PV Sindhu: won a silver at Rio 2016 and a bronze at Tokyo 2020.

Q49. What is the sex ratio (Approx) of India as per Census 2011?

- (a) **940 females per 1000 males**
- (b) 740 females per 1000 males
- (c) 640 females per 1000 males
- (d) 840 females per 1000 males

Solution: 6.(a) 940 females per 1000 males (Approx) Sex ratio: Highest- Kerala (1084); Puducherry (1038); Lowest sex ratio: Haryana (877); Daman and Diu (618).

Q50. 'The White Tiger provides' a darkly humorous perspective of India ' s class struggle in a globalised world. It is written by _____.

- (a) Shashi Tharoor
- (b) Amitav Ghosh
- (c) **Aravind Adiga**
- (d) Vikram Seth

Solution: 14 .(c) Aravind Adiga Books ' The White Tiger ' , ' Amnesty ' , ' Selection Day ' , ' Last Man Tower ' , ' Between the Assassinations ' , ' Milkman ' , ' Girl Woman Other ' .

Q51. _____ festival in the Bastar region is celebrated along with the worship of the local goddess, Kesharpal Kesharpalin Devi.

- (a) **Madai**
- (b) Khatarua
- (c) Harela
- (d) Phool Dei

Solution: 10 .(a) Madai festival in the Bastar region is celebrated along with the worship of the local goddess, Kesharpal Kesharpalin Devi.

Q52. Which Bharatanatyam dancer became the second youngest dancer to be honoured with the 'Padma Shri' award in 1991 ?

- (a) Hema Malini
- (b) Narthaki Nataraj
- (c) Saroj Khan
- (d) **Alarmel Valli**

Solution: 12 .(d) Alarmel Valli became the second youngest dancer to be honoured with the ' Padma Shri ' Award in 1991 . Awards 2002 : Sangeet Natak Akademi Award, New Delhi, 2004 : Padma Bhushan from the Government of India, 2004 : Chevalier of Arts and Letters award from the Government of France, 2012 : Naatya Padmam from Brahma Gana Sabha, Chennai etc.

Q53. Who among the following was the first Finance Minister of Independent India?

- (a) KC Neogy
- (b) CD Deshmukh
- (c) **RK Shanmukham Chetty**
- (d) Liaquat Ali Khan

Solution: 20 .(c) RK Shanmukham Chetty was the first finance minister of Independent India when the country's first budget was tabled in Parliament on 26 November 1947 .

Q54. Flute instruments come under which type of instrument category ?

- (a) Ghana Vadya
- (b) Sushira Vadya**
- (c) Avanaddha Vadya
- (d) Tata Vadya

Solution: 8.(b) Sushira Vadya (Wind instrument). Example - Flute, Shehnai, Nadaswaram. Ghana Vadya - Considered to be the world's first instrument. It does not require tuning. Example - Manjira, Khartal, Chimta, Ghatam, Jaltarang etc. Avanaddha Vadya - Sound produced by striking on animal skin. Example - Tabla, Mridangam, Dhol, Damru etc. Tata Vadya - Sound produced by vibration of a string or chord. Example - Veena, Sitar, Sarangi etc .

Q55. Which of the following pair of "player — sports" is correct? I. Bajrang Punia — Boxing II. Yash Dhull — Cricket

- (a) Only II**
- (b) Only I
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Solution: 10.(a) Only II. Bajrang Punia - Wrestler. Asian Games (Gold - 2018), Commonwealth Games (Gold - 2018), Asian Wrestling Championships (Gold - 2019), Asian Wrestling Championships (Gold - 2017). Awards: Arjuna Award (2015), Padma Shri Award (2019), Raji v Gandhi Khel Ratna Award (2019), FICCI India Sports Awards (2020).

Q56. The length of the pitch in cricket is _____.

- (a) 20 yards
- (b) 24 yards
- (c) 22 yards**
- (d) 18 yards

Solution: 3 .(c) 22 yards . Dimensions of Cricket Wicket - Height of 28" (71.12 cm) and width of 9" (22.86 cm). Bat - Length should be not more than 38 inches (96.5 cm) and the width not more than 4.25 inches (10.8 cm) and made up of Wood only. Ball - Weight between 5.5 ounces and 5.75 ounce, and shall measure between 22.4 cm and 22.9 cm in circumference. Highest Governing Body - International Cricket Council (ICC), Headquarter - Dubai (UAE); Establishment - 15 June 1909. Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI), Headquarter - Mumbai. Establishment - December 1928.

Q57. The ' Hemis Festival ' is celebrated in Ladakh on the 10 th day of the Tibetan Lunar month. To which of the following lords is the festival dedicated?

- (a) Lord Vishnu
- (b) Lord Shiva
- (c) Lord Padmasambhava**
- (d) Lord Ganesha

Solution: 15 .(c) The ' Hemis Festival ' which is celebrated in Ladakh is dedicated to Lord Padmasambhava.

Q58. As per Census 2011, which of the following is India's most populated metropolitan city?

- (a) Kolkata
- (b) Mumbai**
- (c) Delhi
- (d) Chennai

Solution: 10.(b) 3 Most populated metro cities are Mumbai (Maharashtra), Delhi, and Bangalore (Karnataka). The least populated metro cities are Kapurthala (Punjab), Banswara (Rajasthan), Nagda (Madhya Pradesh), and Datia (Madya Pradesh).

Q59. Which of the following is the standard means by which elections are conducted in India?

- (a) Blockchain
- (b) Email
- (c) Ballot paper
- (d) Electronic Voting Machine**

Solution: 9.(d) EVMs were used for the first time in India in 1982 in the by-election to the North Paravur Assembly constituency in Kerala.

Q60. The first Women's Cricket World Cup was hosted by which of the following countries?

- (a) Australia
- (b) West Indies
- (c) England**
- (d) New Zealand

Solution: 15 .(c) England . Women Cricket World Cup: 1973 (first edition) - England (Winner), 2022 - NewZealand (Host), Australia (Winner), ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2024 (Bangladesh), ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026 (England), ICC Women's Cricket World Cup 2025 (India), ICC Women's T20 Champions Trophy 2027 (Sri Lanka). ICC (International Cricket Council): Headquarters - Dubai. Established in 1909.

Q61. ' Jadopatiya ' is a form of _____ popular in the state of Jharkhand.

- (a) music
- (b) dance
- (c) painting**
- (d) sculpture

Solution: 19 .(c) Jadopatiya is a form of painting popular in the state of Jharkhand. These paintings are generally practised by the Santhals in which the artisans make scrolls called Jado or Jadopatia and are drawn with natural inks and colors. These are used as visual aids in storytelling and are said to have magical and healing powers and depict scenes of the afterlife and the Santhal belief of tiger God etc.

Q62. Shiv Kumar Sharma is associated with which instrument?

- (a) Sitar
- (b) Santoor**
- (c) Nadaswaram
- (d) Dholak

Solution: 1.(b) Famous Santoor players: Pandit Shivkumar Sharma, Rahul Sharma, and Tarun Bhattacharya. Sitar Players: Nikhil Banerjee, and Ravi Shankar. Nadaswaram players: Thirumarukal Nadesa Pillai , and T.N. Rajarathnam Pillai. Dholak player: Girish Vishwa.

Q63. Khemraj received the Sangeet Natak Akademi award for his contribution to folk music and dance of 'Kud'. Which state is the folk dance from?

- (a) Haryana
- (b) Jammu and Kashmir**
- (c) Himachal Pradesh
- (d) Punjab

Solution: 10 . (b) Jammu and Kashmir. ' Kud' dance is mainly performed to pay obeisance to the Lok Devtas. Other dances of Jammu and Kashmir : Rouf, Bhand Pather, Hafiza, Dumhal. Major Folk dances of other states: Haryana - Jhumar, Phag, Daph, Dhamal, Loor . Himachal Pradesh - Dangi , Nati , Chham dance. Punjab - Giddha, Bhangra, Kikli.

Q64. In 2019, a minor planet between Mars and Jupiter was named after whom among the following Indian musicians by the International Astronomical Union (IAU)?

- (a) Pt Hari Prasad Chaurasia
- (b) Pt Ravi Shankar
- (c) Ustad Zakir Hussain
- (d) P t Jasraj**

Solution: 9 .(d) Pt Jasraj. The International Astronomical Union (IAU) has named minor planet 2006 VP32 (number -300128), discovered on November 11, 2006, as 'Pandit Jasraj'. He became the first Indian musician to get honored with this unique recognition. Awards : Padma Shri (1975), Sangeet Natak Academy (1987), Padma Bhushan (1990), Padma Vibhushan (2000). Pandit Hari Prasad Chaurasiya - Flute Player, Pandit Ravi Shankar - Sitar Player, Ustad Zakir Hussain - Tabla Player.

Q65. Harmandar Sahib is situated in which city of Punjab?

- (a) Bathinda
- (b) Amritsar**
- (c) Kapurthala
- (d) Patiala

Solution: 5.(b) The Golden Temple (Sri Harmandar Sahib) is a gurdwara located in the city of Amritsar, Punjab, India. It is the preeminent spiritual site of Sikhism. It was built in 1604 by Guru Arjun. Some other spiritual sites of Sikhism are the Gurdwara Darbar Sahib Kartarpur in Kartarpur, and Gurdwara Janam Asthan in Nankana Sahib, etc.

Q66. Thullal is a Solo satiric dance form belonging to the state of _____.

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh
- (b) Haryana
- (c) Kerala**
- (d) Goa

Solution: 18 .(c) Thullal is a satiric dance form belonging to the state of Kerala.

It was introduced by renowned poet Kunchan Nambiar. There are three versions of this art form - Seethankan Thullal, Parayan Thullal and Ottan Thullal - with separate costumes.

Q67. Nati is a folk dance from which of the following states of India?

- (a) Nagaland
- (b) Kerala
- (c) Andhra Pradesh
- (d) Himachal Pradesh**

Solution: 2 .(d) Himachal Pradesh. States and their folk dances: Himachal Pradesh - Rakshasa (demon), Kayang, Bakayang, the Bnayangchu, the Jataru Kayang, Chohara, Shand and Shabu, Lang-dar-ma, Jhanjhar, Jhoor, Gi, and Rasa. Nagaland - Modse, Agurshikukula, Aaluyattu, Sadal Kekai, Changai Dance, Kuki Dance, Leshalaptu, Monyoasho, Rengma, Seecha, Kukui Kucho, Shankai, Moyashai, Zeliang Dance. Kerala - Kathakali, Mohiniyattam, Theyyam, Thiruvathirakali, Kolkali, Ottamthullal, Padayani, Margamkali, Oppana, Koodiyattam. Andhra Pradesh - Kuchipudi, Vilasini Natyam, Andhra Natyam, Bhamakalpam, Veeranatyam, Dappu, Tappeta Gullu, Lambadi, Dhimsa, Kolattam, Butta Bommalu.

Q68. Which of the following trade agreements aims to 'strengthen intra-SAARC economic cooperation to maximize the region's potential for trade and achieve development for their people'?

- (a) APTA
- (b) SAFTA**
- (c) NAFTA
- (d) LAIA

Solution: 1 .(b) SAF TA (South Asian Free Trade Area) - Formed in 2004 at 12th SAARC convention held in Islamabad, Pakistan. Member countries - Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan, Sri Lanka. Headquarter - Kathmandu (Nepal). NAFTA - North American Free Trade Agreement. APTA - Asia-Pacific Trade Agreement. LAIA - Latin American Integration Association. SAARC - South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation.

Q69. 'Aaluyattu' is a folk-dance form from the state of _____.

- (a) Goa
- (b) Nagaland**
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Haryana

Solution: 1 .(b) ' Aaluyattu' is a folk-dance form from the state of Nagaland. This dance is performed by the Konyak tribe of Nagaland. Some other folk dances of Nagaland are Modse, Agurshikukula, Butterfly Dance, Sadal Kekai, Changai Dance, Kuki Dance etc.

Q70. Who is named as the Missile Man of India?

- (a) Vikram Sarabhai
- (b) C. V. Raman
- (c) APJ Abdul Kalam**
- (d) Homi Bhabha

Solution: 3.(c) APJ Abdul Kalam. Missile Woman of India: Tessy Thomas. Bird man of India: Salim Ali. Metro man of India: E Sreedharan. Vikram Sarabhai : Father of the Indian space program. Homi Jehangir Bhabha : Father of the Indian nuclear programme. Chandrasekhara Venkata Raman , was an Indian physicist who won the Nobel Prize in Physics in 1930 for his work on light scattering and the discovery of a new form of scattering called Raman scattering or the Raman effect.

Q71. Which of the following is an autobiography of Barack Obama?

- (a) Chronicles
- (b) Dreams from my Father: A Story of Race and Inheritance**
- (c) Matters of Discretion
- (d) The Test of my life

Solution: 15.(b) Autobiographies of Barack Obama- ' Dreams from My Father: A Story of Race and Inheritance', 'The Audacity of Hope', and 'A Promised Land'. 'Matters of Discretion' (Inder Kumar Gujral), 'The Fry Chronicles' (Stephen Fry), and 'The Test of My Life' (Yuvraj Singh).

Q72. In which state of India is the Nongkrem dance festival celebrated?

- (a) Bihar
- (b) Madhya Pradesh
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Meghalaya**

Solution: 9 .(d) Nongkrem Dance Festival celebrated in Meghalaya. Festivals in

Meghalaya Shad Suk Mynsiem, Behdienkhlam Festival, Shad Sukra, Wangala Festival, Strawberry Festival etc.

Q73. Ratha Jatra, the festival of Chariots of Lord Jagannatha is celebrated every year in _____

- (a) Puri, Odisha**
- (b) Sarnath, Uttar Pradesh
- (c) Jaipur, Rajasthan
- (d) Kolkata, West Bengal

Solution: 1.(a) Puri, Odisha. Ratha Yatra (also known as Car Festival) is celebrated every year on the second (Dwitiya) day of Shukla paksha of Ashadha Masa (3rd month of the Odia calendar). The Chariot of Lord Jagannath is called Nandighosha . Famous festivals of Odisha: Nabakalebara, Bali Jatra, Dhanu Yatra, Eco Retreat, Sume-Gelirak, K onark dance festival, Nuakhai (harvest festival), Raja Parba, Chatar Jatra etc.

Q74. Which of the following festivals is associated with Rajasthan?

- (a) Gudi Padwa
- (b) Bundi Utsav**
- (c) Bonalu
- (d) Matho Narang

Solution: 11.(b) Famous festivals of Rajasthan: Pushkar Camel Fair, Festival of Urs, Gangaur, Nagaur fair, Chandrabhaga Fair, Bundi Utsav, Kumbhalgarh festival, Baneshwar festival, Kolayat Fair, etc. Gudi Padwa (Maharashtra), Bonalu (Telangana), and Matho Narang (Ladakh).

Q75. In which state of India is the Wangala festival celebrated?

- (a) Meghalaya**
- (b) Kerala
- (c) Goa
- (d) Jharkhand

Solution: 13 .(a) Wangala Festival of Meghalaya is a most popular festival among the Garos of Meghalaya, India. Wangala Festival is a harvest festival held in honour of Saljong, the Sun-god of fertility.

Q76. Who among the following Indian musicians received the 'Best Original Song' award for his composition in 'Slumdog Millionaire', at Oscars 2009?

- (a) AR Rahman**
- (b) Asha Bhosle
- (c) Lata Mangeshkar
- (d) Gulzar

Solution: 12.(a) AR Rahman. He was awarded the Grammy Award for Best Song Written for Visual Media (2010), Jai Ho! (You Are My Destiny) Padma Shri (2000), Padma Bhushan (2010), etc.

Q77. The Kamaicha is a bowed flute played by the Manganiars of:

- (a) west Rajasthan**
- (b) west Goa
- (c) west Bihar
- (d) west Kerala

Solution: 7 .(a) The Kamaicha is a bowed lute played by the Manganiars of west Rajasthan. It is a stringed instrument made of steel, parchment, gut, metal, shisham, and horsehair.

Q78. Thangka painting style depicts _____ deity.

- (a) Islamic
- (b) Buddhist**
- (c) Jewish
- (d) Hindu

Solution: 14.(b) Buddhist. Thangka Painting is a Tibetan Buddhist Painting painted on cotton and silk cloths. Founder of Buddhism - Gautama Buddha. Indian Painting Style: Madhubani paintings - Bihar, Warli Painting - Maharashtra, Phad painting - Rajasthan, Kalighat Painting - Calcutta, Patachitra painting - Odisha etc.

Q79. Who is the author of the book 'Modi Government: New Surge of Communalism'?

- (a) Pranab Mukherjee
- (b) Jaswant Singh
- (c) Sitaram Yechury**
- (d) M J Akbar

Solution: 4.(c) Sitaram Yechury books: Socialism in a Changing World, Left

Hand Drive: Concrete Analysis of Concrete Conditions, Modi Government: New Surge of Communalism, Communalism vs. Secularism, and Ghrina Ki Rajniti.

(b) Lata Mangeshkar

(c) Asha Bhosle

(d) **Tanvi Shah**

Q80. Who is the first Indian woman to win the Grammy Award?

(a) Sunidhi Chauhan

Solution: 7 .(d) Tanvi Shah became the first woman to win the Grammy award for her work in Jai Ho in Slumdog Millionaire.